

GUILLAUME ST-ONGE

Assistant Professor

School of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science

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Network Science | Stochastic Processes | Dynamical Systems | Bayesian Inference | Contagion

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Assistant Professor | School of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science, University of Ottawa 2026–present

Research Assistant Professor | Department of Physics, Northeastern University 2024–2026

- Core faculty at the [Network Science Institute](#) & [Roux Institute](#)
- Member of [EPISTORM—Center for Advanced Epidemic Analytics and Predictive Modeling Technology](#)

Postdoctoral Research Associate | Department of Physics, Northeastern University 2022–2024

- Advisor: Alessandro Vespignani
- FRQNT: Postdoctoral Fellow

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Physics | Université Laval 2018–2022

- Advisors: Antoine Allard and Laurent Hébert-Dufresne (co-advisor)
- Thesis title: *Contagion process on complex networks beyond pairwise interactions*

M.Sc. in Physics | Université Laval 2015–2017

- Advisor: Louis J. Dubé
- Thesis title: *Propagation dynamics on random networks: characterization of the phase transition*

B.Sc. in Physics | Université Laval 2012–2015

FUNDING AND AWARDS

Grants

- [Gates Foundation](#): *Advancing Global Pathogen Detection through Aircraft and WES* (\$1 463 735 USD, co-PI) 2025

Postdoctoral research

- [FRQNT: Postdoctoral Research Fellowship](#) (\$110 000) June 2022–June 2024

Graduate research

- [NSERC: Doctoral Scholarship – Alexander Graham Bell Canada](#) (\$105 000) Jan. 2018–Dec. 2020
- [FRQNT: Doctoral Scholarship*](#) (\$60 000) Jan. 2018–Dec. 2020
- [NSERC: Master Scholarship – Alexander Graham Bell Canada](#) (\$17 500) Sept. 2015–Aug. 2016
- [FRQNT: Master Scholarship](#) (\$30 000) Sept. 2015–Aug. 2017
- [Desjardins Foundation: Master Scholarship*](#) (\$3 000) Oct. 2015

*Awarded but declined

Internship research

- [FRQNT: International Internship Program](#) (\$7 500) 2020
- [NSERC: Michael Smith Foreign Study Supplements](#) (\$6 000) 2019
- [NSERC: Undergraduate Student Research Award](#) (\$4 500, Awarded 3 times) 2013, 2014, 2015

Awards and honours

- [Honour List of the Faculty of Graduate and Postdoctoral Studies](#) | Ph.D. Thesis[†] 2022
- Best presentation, [Fourth Northeast Regional Conference on Complex Systems](#) 2021
- [Honour List of the Faculty of Graduate and Postdoctoral Studies](#) | M.Sc. Thesis[†] 2017
- [Concours d'expression scientifique Pierre Amiot](#) (science popularization, 3rd place), Université Laval 2017
- [Governor General's Academic Medal \(silver\) for Highest Academic Standing](#) | B.Sc. 2016
- Student merit award, Physics Department, Université Laval 2015
- Pedagogue of the year, Physics Students Association, Université Laval 2014

TEACHING

- *Dynamical Processes in Complex Networks*, guest lecturer 2022–2025
Presentation title: Branching process and probability generating functions in network science
- Teaching assistant:
 - *Statistical Physics*, teaching assistant 2016–2018, 2020
 - *Computational Physics*, teaching assistant 2016, 2018
 - *Mathematical Physics III*, teaching assistant 2014
 - *Mathematical Physics I, II*, teaching assistant 2013
- Book in preparation: [CoSMOS: Complex Systems Modeling Open Sourcebooks](#)

PUBLICATIONS AND PATENTS

Articles published or accepted in a peer-reviewed journal

24. [A vision for estimation of the instantaneous reproductive number](#)
C. W. Milando, G. G. Vega Yon, K. Johnson, A. Urbinati, **G. St-Onge**, B. Klein, A. Cori,
L. F. White, Rt Collabathon participants 2026
Epidemics. 54, 100885
23. [Pandemic monitoring with global aircraft-based wastewater surveillance networks](#)
G. St-Onge, J. T. Davis, L. Hébert-Dufresne, A. Allard, A. Urbinati, S. V. Scarpino, M. Chinazzi, A. Vespignani 2025
Nature Medicine. 31, 788–796
22. [Characteristic scales and adaptation in higher-order contagions](#)
G. Burgio, **G. St-Onge**, L. Hébert-Dufresne 2025
Nature Communications. 16, 4589
21. [One pathogen does not an epidemic make: A review of interacting contagions, diseases, beliefs, and stories](#)
L. Hébert-Dufresne, Y.-Y. Ahn, V. Colizza, A. Allard, J. W. Crothers, P. Sheridan Dodds, M. Galesic,
F. Ghanbarnejad, D. Gravel, R. A. Hammond, K. Lerman, J. Lovato, J. J. Openshaw, S. Redner, S. V. Scarpino,
G. St-Onge, T. R. Tangherlini, J.-G. Young 2025
npj Complexity. 2, 26

[†]Highest overall mark by all committee members

20. [Ensemble²: scenarios ensembling for communication and performance analysis](#)
C. Bay, **G. St-Onge**, J. T. Davis, M. Chinazzi, E. Howerton, J. Lessler, M. C. Runge, K. Shea, S. Truelove, C. Viboud, A. Vespignani
Epidemics. 46, 100748 2024
19. [Nonlinear bias toward complex contagion in uncertain transmission settings](#)
G. St-Onge, L. Hébert-Dufresne, A. Allard
Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences of the United States of America. 121, e2312202121 2024
18. [Hierarchical team structure and multidimensional localization \(or siloing\) on networks](#)
L. Hébert-Dufresne, **G. St-Onge**, J. Meluso, J. Bagrow, A. Allard
Journal of Physics: Complexity. 4, 035002 2023
17. [Source-sink behavioural dynamics limit institutional evolution in a group-structured society](#)
L. Hébert-Dufresne, T. M. Waring, **G. St-Onge**, M. T. Niles, L. K. Corlew, M. P. Dube, S. J. Miller, N. J. Gotelli, B. J. McGill
Royal Society Open Science. 9, 211743 2022
16. [Influential groups for seeding and sustaining nonlinear contagion in heterogeneous hypergraphs](#)
G. St-Onge, I. Iacopini, V. Latora, A. Barrat, G. Petri, A. Allard, L. Hébert-Dufresne
Communications Physics. 5, 25 2022
15. [Universal Nonlinear Infection Kernel from Heterogeneous Exposure on Higher-Order Networks](#)
G. St-Onge, H. Sun, A. Allard, L. Hébert-Dufresne, G. Bianconi
Physical Review Letters. 127, 158301 2021
14. [Social Confinement and Mesoscopic Localization of Epidemics on Networks](#)
G. St-Onge, V. Thibeault, A. Allard, L. J. Dubé, L. Hébert-Dufresne
Physical Review Letters. 126, 098301 2021
13. [Inference, Model Selection, and the Combinatorics of Growing Trees](#)
G. T. Cantwell, **G. St-Onge**, J.-G. Young
Physical Review Letters. 126, 038301 2021
12. [Master equation analysis of mesoscopic localization in contagion dynamics on higher-order networks](#)
G. St-Onge, V. Thibeault, A. Allard, L. J. Dubé, L. Hébert-Dufresne
Physical Review E. 103, 032301 2021
11. [Localization, epidemic transitions, and unpredictability of multistrain epidemics with an underlying genotype network](#)
B. J. M. Blake, **G. St-Onge**, L. Hébert-Dufresne
PLOS Computational Biology. 17, e1008606 2021
10. [Threefold way to the dimension reduction of dynamics on networks: an application to synchronization](#)
V. Thibeault, **G. St-Onge**, L. J. Dubé, P. Desrosiers
Physical Review Research. 2, 043215 2020
9. [Network comparison and the within-ensemble graph distance](#)
H. Hartle, B. Klein, S. McCabe, A. Daniels, **G. St-Onge**, C. Murphy, L. Hébert-Dufresne
Proceedings of the Royal Society A. 476, 20190744 2020
8. [Thresholding normally distributed data creates complex networks](#)
G. T. Cantwell, Y. Liu, B. F. Maier, A. C. Schwarze, C. A. Serván, J. Snyder, **G. St-Onge**
Physical Review E. 101, 062302 2020
7. [Phase transition in the recoverability of network history](#)
J.-G. Young, **G. St-Onge**, E. Laurence, C. Murphy, L. Hébert-Dufresne, P. Desrosiers
Physical Review X. 9, 041056 2019
6. [Efficient sampling of spreading processes on complex networks using a composition and rejection algorithm](#)
G. St-Onge, J.-G. Young, L. Hébert-Dufresne, L. J. Dubé
Computer Physics Communications. 240, 30 2019
5. [Universality of the stochastic block model](#)
J.-G. Young, **G. St-Onge**, P. Desrosiers, L. J. Dubé
Physical Review E. 98, 032309 2018

4. [Phase transition of the susceptible-infected-susceptible dynamics on time-varying configuration model networks](#)
G. St-Onge, J.-G. Young, E. Laurence, C. Murphy, L. J. Dubé
Physical Review E. 97, 022305 2018
3. [Geometric evolution of complex networks with degree correlations](#)
C. Murphy, A. Allard, E. Laurence, G. St-Onge, L. J. Dubé
Physical Review E. 97, 032309 2018
2. [Exact vectorial model for nonparaxial focusing by arbitrary axisymmetric surfaces](#)
D. Panneton, G. St-Onge, M. Piché, S. Thibault
Journal of the Optical Society of America A. 33, 801 2016
1. [Needles of light produced with a spherical mirror](#)
D. Panneton, G. St-Onge, M. Piché, S. Thibault
Optics Letters. 4, 419 2015

Preprints and submitted manuscripts

- [The impact of behavioral homophily and conformity on epidemic spreading in networks with large groups](#)
O. Ribordy, C. Granell, G. St-Onge, L. Hébert-Dufresne, A. Arenas, A. Allard
arXiv:2605.25875.
- [Simpson's paradox explains the ubiquity of nonlinear, threshold, and complex contagions](#)
L. Hébert-Dufresne, A. Allard, J.-G. Young, W. H. W. Thompson, G. St-Onge
arXiv:2605.00791.
- [Group dynamics shape contagion onsets and multistable active phases under collective reinforcement](#)
S. Lamata-Otín, F. Malizia, L. A. Keating, G. St-Onge, V. Latora, J. Gómez-Gardeñes, L. Hébert-Dufresne
arXiv:2603.28566.
- [A multi-scale model to evaluate airport wastewater surveillance and ICU genomic monitoring for pandemic preparedness](#)
B. K. Reddy, J. L.-H. Tsui, K. O. Drake, G. St-Onge, J. T. Davis, C. Mills, J. Dunning, I. I. Bogoch, S. V. Scarpino, S. Bhatt, O. G. Pybus, A. Rambaut, M. J. Wade, T. Ward, M. Chand, E. M. Volz, A. Vespignani, M. U. G. Kraemer
medRxiv 2026.02.27.26347250.
- [Evaluation of stochastic trajectory-based epidemic models using the energy score](#)
C. Bay, K. Mu, G. St-Onge, M. Chinazzi, J. T. Davis, A. Vespignani
medRxiv 2025.01.13.25320493.
- [Detecting structural perturbations from time series with deep learning](#)
E. Laurence, C. Murphy, G. St-Onge, X. Roy-Pomerleau, V. Thibeault
arXiv:2006.05232.

Patents

- [Hybrid nanocomposite materials, laser scanning system and use thereof in volumetric image projection](#),
C. Allen, S. Thibault, A. Talbot-Lanciault, P. Blais, G. St-Onge, P. Desaulniers 2017
CA Patent No. 2983656

TALKS AND INVITED PRESENTATIONS

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- [Global Epidemic Modeling to Evaluate and Inform Wastewater Surveillance Systems](#)
[Wastewater Environmental Surveillance Meeting](#) (invited), Ghana 2026
 - [Generating function framework for spatiotemporal computational epidemiology](#)
[Epidemics: 10th International Conference on Infectious Disease Dynamics](#), San Diego (CA), USA 2025
 - [Future fronts: Computational Epidemiology](#) (panel discussion, panelist)
[Charting Complexity](#), London, UK 2025
 - [Model Design and Systematic Biases in Contagion Dynamics](#)
[SIAM Conference on Applications of Dynamical Systems \(DS25\)](#) (invited),
minisymposium *Inference and Prediction in Complex Social Systems*, Denver (CO), USA 2025

- *Modeling Platform for Travel-Based Genomic and Wastewater Outbreak Surveillance* 2025
 - [InsightNet Annual Meeting](#), Salt Lake City (UT), USA
 - [Epistorm Annual Meeting](#), Boston (MA), USA
- *The Unreasonable Effectiveness of Branching Processes for Outbreak Analytics* 2025

Network Science Research Symposium (keynote presentation), Boston (MA), USA
- *L'efficacité hors norme des fonctions génératrices pour modéliser les épidémies* 2025

[Centre Interdisciplinaire en Modélisation Mathématique de l'Université Laval](#), Québec (QC), Canada
- *Statistical physics of epidemics with applications to global biosurveillance* 2025

[PHYS 7210 - Introduction to Research in Physics \(seminar\)](#), Northeastern University, Boston (MA), USA
- *Generating function methodology for metapopulation epidemics with applications to global biosurveillance* 2024

[Quantitative Methods for Dynamics on Networks](#), Los Alamos (NM), USA (invited)
- *Optimization of a global wastewater surveillance network at airports for emerging pathogens* 2024

[International School and Conference on Network Science](#), Québec (QC), Canada
- *Establishing a wastewater global surveillance network at airports for early detection of emerging pathogens: A modeling study* 2023

[Epidemics: 9th International Conference on Infectious Disease Dynamics](#), Bologna, Italy
- *Wastewater environmental Surveillance for Pandemic Preparedness (roundtable discussion, panelist)* 2023

[Grand Challenges Annual Meeting](#), Dakar, Senegal
- *Probability generating functions for epidemics on metapopulation networks* 2023
 - [Contagion on Complex Social Systems \(CCSS\)](#), Burlington (VT), USA
 - [International School and Conference on Network Science](#), Vienna, Austria
- *Quantifying population dynamics of complex contagions* 2023

[International School and Conference on Network Science](#), Vienna, Austria
- *Navigating wastewater surveillance at airports with probability generating functions* 2023

[NetPLACE](#), (invited, virtual)
- *Indistinguishability of simple and complex contagions when transmission settings matter* 2023

[Mathematical Institute, University of Oxford](#), Oxford, UK (invited, virtual)
- *Confounders of interacting diseases* 2023

[Dynamics of Interacting Contagions](#), Santa Fe (NM), USA
- *Reconstruction Of Product-Diffusion Cascades* 2022

[Workshop on Network Dynamics and Choice Theory](#), Burlington (VT), USA
- *Nonlinear infection rate to compress mechanistic epidemic models* 2022

[Fourth Northeast Regional Conference on Complex Systems](#), Buffalo (NY), USA
- *Influential groups in hypergraph contagions* 2022

[Max Planck Institute for Mathematics in the Sciences](#), Leipzig, Germany (invited, virtual)
- *Bursty exposure on higher-order networks leads to nonlinear infection kernels* 2021
 - [Networks 2021: A Joint Sunbelt and NetSci Conference](#), Bloomington (IN), USA
 - [SIAM Conference on Applications of Dynamical Systems \(DS21\)](#), Portland (OR), USA
 - [Fourth Northeast Regional Conference on Complex Systems](#), Buffalo (NY), USA 🏆 (best talk)
- *Influence maximization in simplicial contagion* 2020

[International School and Conference on Network Science](#), Rome, Italy
- *Localization, bistability and optimal seeding of contagions on higher-order networks* 2020

[Artificial Life Conference](#), Montreal (QC), Canada
- *Mesosopic localization of spreading processes on networks* 2019

[International School and Conference on Network Science](#), Burlington (VT), USA
- *SIS dynamics on time-varying random networks* 2017

[Institute for Disease Modeling](#), Seattle (WA), USA

- *Susceptible-infected-susceptible dynamics on the rewired configuration model*
[International School and Conference on Network Science](#), Indianapolis (IN), USA 2017
- *Co-evolution of Growth and Dynamics on Network*
[International School and Conference on Network Science](#), Seoul, Republic of Korea 2016
- *Modeling ultra-sharp needles of light using vector diffraction theory*
[50th Canadian Undergraduate Physics Conference](#), Kingston (ON), Canada 2014

OTHER RELEVANT EXPERIENCES

Internships

Vermont Complex System Center, Burlington (VT), USA

- Visiting graduate student | group of Prof. Laurent Hébert-Dufresne 2019-2020
Project: *Temporal reconstruction of networks with message-passing*

Université Laval, Québec (QC), Canada

- Undergraduate research assistant | group of Prof. Louis J. Dubé 2015
Project: *Statistical physics of complex networks*
- Undergraduate research assistant | group of Prof. Michel Piché 2014
Project: *Highly focused laser beam modeling*
- Undergraduate research assistant | group of Prof. Claudine Allen 2013
Project: *Development of an optical system for biodetection*

Schools and workshops

- AI for Disease Modeling Convening, Dakar, Senegal 2025
- [Summer Institute in Statistics and Modeling in Infectious Diseases](#), (virtual) 2022
- [Complex Systems Summer School](#), Santa Fe (NM), USA 2018
- [Complex Networks Winter Workshop](#), Québec (QC), Canada 2018

LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE

Conferences and workshops

- Satellite co-chair: [International School and Conference on Network Science \(NetSci\)](#), Boston (MA), USA 2026
– Flagship conference of the [Network Science Society](#)
- Co-organizer: [The Art of Epidemics: Data Storytelling through Effective Visualizations](#) 2025
– Special session at [Epidemics 10: 10th International Conference on Infectious Disease Dynamics](#)
- School & Satellite co-chair: [International School and Conference on Network Science \(NetSci\)](#) 2024
– Flagship conference of the [Network Science Society](#)
– Elected *Scientific Event of the Year* by the [Cercle des ambassadeurs de Québec](#) 🏆
- Co-organizer: [Epistorm Rt-Collabathon](#) 2024
– Collaborative event to build community around real-time estimation of the effective reproduction number
– Supported by the [CDC's Center for Forecasting and Outbreak Analytics Insight Net initiative](#)
- Program committees:
– [Conference on Complex Systems \(CCS\)](#) 2024-2025
– [Northeast Regional Conference on Complex Systems \(NERCCS\)](#) 2022
- Session chair:
– [Networks 2021: A Joint Sunbelt and NetSci Conference, S14 – Epidemiology](#) 2021
– [SIAM Conference on Applications of Dynamical Systems \(DS21\), CP4 – Dynamics](#) 2021
- Projects liaison: [Complex Networks Winter Workshop](#) 2019

Faculty committee

- Member: Full Time Non-Tenure Track Faculty Committee, College of Science, Northeastern University 2024–2026
- Member: PhD Admission Committee, Network Science, Northeastern University 2025

Reviewer

- Journals (17): [Science Advances](#), [Nature Communications](#), [Physical Review Letters](#), [Physical Review X](#), [Physical Review E](#), [PLOS Computational Biology](#), [npj Complexity](#), [PNAS Nexus](#), [Journal of The Royal Society Interface](#), [Journal of Complex Networks](#), [Communications Physics](#), [Scientific Reports](#), [Chaos: An Interdisciplinary Journal of Nonlinear Science](#), [New Journal of Physics](#), [IMA Journal of Applied Mathematics](#), [Advances in Complex Systems](#), [PLOS One](#)
- Triage grading for [The Interdisciplinary Contest in Modeling \(ICM\)](#) 2022

MEDIA COVERAGE

- Selection of media coverage on our *Nature Medicine* article about aircraft wastewater surveillance: 2025
 - [Thinking globally for pandemic early warning systems](#), *Nature News and Views*
 - [Wastewater sampling could be key to early warning of new disease outbreaks](#), *The Guardian*
 - [Waste surveillance at just 20 airports could spot the next pandemic](#), *NewScientist*
 - [How monitoring wastewater from international flights can serve as an early warning system for the next pandemic](#), *Northeastern Global News*
- Other media coverage of my research:
 - [Mathematical model offers new insights into spread of epidemics](#), *phys.org* 2021
 - [To find the right network model, compare all possible histories](#), *phys.org* 2021
 - [How large a gathering is too large during the coronavirus pandemic?](#), *Science News* 2020

SELECTED OPEN-SOURCE SOFTWARE

- **pgfgleam**: efficient solution of stochastic metapopulation epidemics for global biosurveillance (Python)
- **SamplableSet**: implementation of sets which can be randomly sampled efficiently (C++/Python)
- **fasttr**: uniform sampler for the temporal reconstruction of growing trees (C++/Python)
- **spreading_CR**: stochastic simulation algorithm for contagion processes (C++/Python)